Abdullah, was sidelined in what was to become a feudal order. Beg was expelled from the National Conference and his efforts to set up his own party, the *Inquilabi* (Revolutionary) National Conference, never really took off and his political career faded away. Thus, Beg, the godfather of the 'transients' within the 'twilight zone', was no longer there to shepherd his flock. He died in 1982, abandoned by his friends and beneficiaries.

In an address on 13 July 1980, Abdullah declared that 'no one would be allowed to enslave us again, whether it is India or Pakistan'. He had not, it seemed, abandoned his dream of an independent Jammu and Kashmir. Indira Gandhi was extremely annoyed at this and at a meeting with Abdullah in New Delhi, on 22 July 1980, she evidently made her feelings plain. Abdullah backed down a bit, as he had often done in the past. Gandhi, however, was not convinced. Through 1981, Abdullah resolved to loosen his grip on the reins of power and hand over the control of the state to his son Dr Farooq Abdullah, who, in 1981, became the President of the National Conference.

Dr Farooq Abdullah was now the heir apparent. Even though his political views were not clear at this juncture, it was evident that he wanted no less autonomy than his father. At the very least, he would fight for a return to the pre-1953 position. As support for the Abdullah's began to wane, the Jammu and Kashmir Resettlement Act of 1982—that took advantage of Article 7 of the Indian Constitution allowing migrants to enter Pakistan after Partition to resettle if any law permits them to do so—was initiated to allow Kashmiris, who had migrated to Pakistan, as state subjects. The fact that such an act would go against nationalist emotions across India was ignored. When Abdullah died in October 1982, Indira Gandhi had attended his funeral.

Enter Farooq Abdullah

A challenge to Farooq's succession was mounted by Ghulam Mohammed Shah, the husband of Khalida, Abdullah's favourite child. Farooq Abdullah eventually became Chief Minister after the elections of 1983, though not